

Alex Rivera

Backend Engineer — distributed systems & developer tooling
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SUMMARY

Backend engineer with six years building high-throughput services. Comfortable owning a system end to end, from schema design through on-call. Recent focus on cutting latency and cost in data-heavy pipelines.

EDUCATION

- University of Texas at Austin** Austin, TX
• *B.S. Computer Science; GPA 3.8/4.0* 2015 – 2019
Coursework: Distributed Systems, Databases, Compilers.

SKILLS SUMMARY

- Languages:** Python, Go, TypeScript, SQL
- Infrastructure:** PostgreSQL, Kafka, Redis, Kubernetes, Terraform
- Practices:** Distributed systems design, Observability, CI/CD, Incident response

EXPERIENCE

- Northwind Data** Austin, TX
• *Senior Software Engineer* Mar 2022 – Present
 - Rebuilt the ingestion pipeline around a partitioned queue, raising sustained throughput from 4k to 26k events/second.
 - Cut p99 API latency by 63% by replacing per-request joins with a materialised read model.
 - Led the migration of 40+ services to structured logging, reducing mean incident triage time from 22 to 8 minutes.
 - Mentored three engineers; two were promoted within the year.
- Cobalt Systems** Remote
• *Software Engineer* Jul 2019 – Feb 2022
 - Designed and shipped the public REST API now used by 1,200+ integration partners.
 - Introduced contract testing across service boundaries, eliminating a recurring class of deploy-time regressions.
 - Reduced cloud spend 18% by right-sizing workloads and consolidating idle clusters.

PROJECTS

- queuelite (Author):** A dependency-free job queue for Postgres, 2.1k stars. Exactly-once delivery via advisory locks and a visibility timeout, with no external broker. (2023 – Present)

PUBLICATIONS

- Backpressure Without Tears: Practical Flow Control in Event Pipelines:** A. Rivera, J. Okonkwo. USENIX SREcon Americas. 2024.